Global Employee Workplace Handbook & Code of Conduct

Classification: Internal Corporate Directive · Version: 4.0 · Department: General Hr

1. Organizational Mission, Hybrid & Remote Work Policy

Acme Global Enterprise is dedicated to fostering an ethical, inclusive, and high-performance workplace. All team members must uphold integrity, transparency, and legal compliance across all global operations.

1.1 Core Collaboration Hours: Acme operates on a hybrid schedule. Mandatory core collaboration hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM Eastern Standard Time (EST), Monday through Thursday. During these hours, all personnel must be reachable via Slack, Zoom, and corporate email.

1.2 On-Site Attendance: Office-based employees must be on-site at least two (2) days per week, specifically Tuesday and Thursday.

1.3 Remote Work Setup Stipend: Fully remote employees receive a one-time tax-free home-office technology stipend of $500 USD upon hire for ergonomic chairs, monitors, or desks. Remote employees are also eligible for an ongoing monthly home broadband internet stipend of $50 USD.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO), Leaves of Absence & Parental Leave

2.1 Vacation Entitlement: Permanent full-time employees accrue 20 paid vacation days per calendar year. A maximum of five (5) unused vacation days may be rolled over into the next year, which must be redeemed before March 31.

2.2 Sick and Mental Health Leave: All employees receive 10 paid sick days annually. Formal medical documentation is required only for continuous absences exceeding three (3) consecutive working days.

2.3 Paid Parental Leave: Acme offers sixteen (16) weeks of 100% fully paid parental leave for all eligible primary and secondary caregivers following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Leave must be taken within twelve (12) months of the qualifying event.

2.4 Corporate Holidays: Acme recognizes twelve (12) official paid holidays per year, including Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving (Thursday & Friday), and Winter Break (Dec 24-25).

3. Healthcare, Retirement Benefits & Learning Stipend

3.1 Health Insurance: Acme provides comprehensive medical, dental, and vision insurance beginning on the employee's very first day of employment. Acme pays 85% of employee coverage premiums and 70% of dependent coverage.

3.2 401(k) Matching: Acme matches 100% of employee 401(k) contributions up to the first 4% of base pay, plus 50% on the next 2%, delivering a maximum company match of 5%. All employer matching contributions vest immediately on day one.

3.3 Professional Development Budget: Every permanent employee is allocated an annual learning budget of $1,500 USD for professional certifications, industry conferences, and approved academic coursework.

4. Performance Reviews, Promotions & Improvement Plans

4.1 Review Cycles: Performance evaluations occur bi-annually in June (mid-year check-in) and December (annual focal review). Reviews incorporate 360-degree peer feedback, self-evaluations, and measurable Objectives and Key Results (OKRs).

4.2 Promotion Criteria: Promotions require sustained performance at the next career band for at least six (6) consecutive months, manager recommendation, and calibration approval by the Department Compensation Committee.

4.3 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP): If an employee's performance fails to meet role expectations, a formal 60-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is established with clear weekly milestones. If satisfactory performance is not achieved after 60 days, employment may be terminated with standard severance.

5. Moonlighting, Secondary Employment & Conflicts of Interest

5.1 Outside Employment: Employees may engage in outside freelancing or teaching provided it does not interfere with Acme obligations. Secondary employment must be declared and pre-cleared via the Legal Compliance Portal.

5.2 Strict Prohibitions: Employees may never perform work for an Acme competitor, consult for an active vendor, or utilize Acme hardware, software licenses, or intellectual property for outside commercial ventures. Outside work is capped at a maximum of 15 hours per calendar week.

6. Resignation, Severance & Hardware Offboarding

6.1 Notice Period: Individual contributors are requested to provide two (2) weeks written notice of resignation. Managers and Directors must provide four (4) weeks advance written notice.

6.2 Severance Entitlement: In involuntary non-disciplinary reductions in force (RIF), severance is provided at two (2) weeks of base pay per completed year of tenure, with a minimum of four (4) weeks and a maximum cap of twenty-six (26) weeks.

6.3 Equipment Return: All company-issued hardware, including laptops, security keys, and corporate credit cards, must be returned to IT Asset Management within five (5) business days of the termination date via prepaid courier box.